



Louise Thomson
THE PLAYBOOK

THE COMPLETE GUIDE · 2026

CREATOR · SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGER · BUSINESS OWNER

The Complete Creator Playbook

The full step-by-step system — from your first post to a paid, full-time business. Content, social media management, branding, websites, pricing and growth. Everything, in order.

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START HERE

Read this first.

This is the guide I wish I'd had when I started. No fluff, no gatekeeping — just the exact steps I used to go from a 9–5 to a full-time creator and business owner, written so a complete beginner can follow it.

You do not need to be famous, technical, or lucky. You need a skill people pay for, a system to deliver it, and the consistency to keep going. That's learnable — and it's all in here.

How to use this playbook

- ◆ **Go in order the first time.** Each module builds on the last — foundations, then the three ways to earn, then branding, websites, pricing and growth.
- ◆ **Do the actions.** Every module ends with a step to take. Reading changes nothing; doing changes everything.
- ◆ **Pick one path to start.** Content creator, social media manager, or your own business — you can add the others later.
- ◆ **Keep it beside you.** Come back to the pricing, scripts and checklists whenever you need them.

A promise: if you finish this guide and take the actions, you will know exactly how to earn your first £1,000 online — and how to turn that into a full-time income.



WHAT'S INSIDE

Eight modules to full-time freedom.

01	Foundations & Mindset	p04
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The big picture: Modules 1–2 get you creating and growing. Module 3 turns that skill into paid client work. Modules 4–5 make you look professional and add services. Module 6 makes sure you get paid properly. Modules 7–8 scale it into a real business.

A woman with long brown hair, wearing a leopard print dress, is sitting at a bar. She is looking towards the camera with a slight smile. Her right arm is raised, touching her hair. The bar has a marble top and a backlit shelf filled with various liquor bottles. In the background, there are more bottles and a warm, ambient light.

MODULE 01

Foundations & Mindset

Before the tactics: the opportunity, the paths, your niche, and the numbers you're aiming at. Get this right and everything else gets easier.

The opportunity

Choose your path

Find your niche

Set your goals



THE OPPORTUNITY

The best time in history to start.

The creator economy is one of the fastest-growing industries on earth — and businesses everywhere now need people who understand social media. You are early, not late.

£0

Startup cost — you already own a phone

2–3 hrs

A day is enough to start on the side

Global

Your market is the whole internet

Why this works now

- ✦ **Every business needs content.** Most owners have no time and no clue — they'll happily pay you to do it.
- ✦ **Attention is the new currency.** If you can hold attention, you can earn from it in a dozen ways.
- ✦ **The tools are free.** The same phone in your pocket built million-pound brands.
- ✦ **You can start tiny.** One client, one video, one product — then compound.

Reframe: you're not "trying to go viral." You're building a **skill set** — content, growth, and management — that the market pays for whether you have 500 followers or 5 million.



CHOOSE YOUR PATH

Three ways to earn.

There are three routes into this industry. They overlap, and most people eventually run all three — but pick **one** to start so you actually make progress.



Content Creator

You grow your own audience and get paid through brand deals, UGC, affiliates and your own products.

Best if: you want to build a personal brand



Social Media Manager

You run social accounts for other businesses on a monthly fee. Reliable, recurring income — fast.

Best if: you want money soonest



Business Owner

You package it all — agency, websites, products, coaching — into a company that can run without you.

Best if: you want to scale big

Which should you start with?

- ✦ **Need income in 30 days?** Start as a **Social Media Manager** — you can land a paying client before you have any following.
- ✦ **Love being on camera?** Start as a **Content Creator** and add management once you understand the platforms.
- ✦ **Already have a following or a skill?** Go straight to **Business Owner** and productise it.

Do this now: circle the path that fits you today. You'll follow its module first — but read them all.



FIND YOUR NICHE

Get specific. Get paid.

"I'll post about everything" is the fastest way to grow nothing. A niche makes you easy to follow, easy to book, and easy to recommend.

The niche formula

Passion × Skill × Demand. Something you enjoy, something you're decent at (or willing to learn), and something people already spend money on.

Proven, profitable niches

- ✦ Beauty & skincare
- ✦ Fitness & wellness
- ✦ Fashion & styling
- ✦ Food & recipes
- ✦ Travel & lifestyle
- ✦ Home & interiors
- ✦ Money & business
- ✦ Parenting & family
- ✦ Local business (huge for SMM)
- ✦ Tech, gaming & AI

Niche down with the "who + what + why"

- ✦ **Who** you help — e.g. "busy mums", "local gyms", "new coaches".
- ✦ **What** you help them do — "eat well in 15 minutes", "get more members".
- ✦ **Why** you — your story, your taste, your results.

Do this now: write one sentence — "I help [who] to [what] through [content/social media]." That's your positioning.



SET YOUR GOALS

Aim at a real number.

Vague goals get vague results. Decide what you want to earn and work backwards — the internet doesn't cap your income, so the target is yours to set.

Example income ladders

Level	What it looks like	Monthly
Side income	1 SMM client or a few UGC videos	£500–£1,000
Part-time	2–3 clients or steady brand deals	£1,500–£3,000
Full-time	Replace the 9–5, mixed income streams	£4,000–£8,000
Scaling	Agency / products / big deals	£10,000–£20,000+

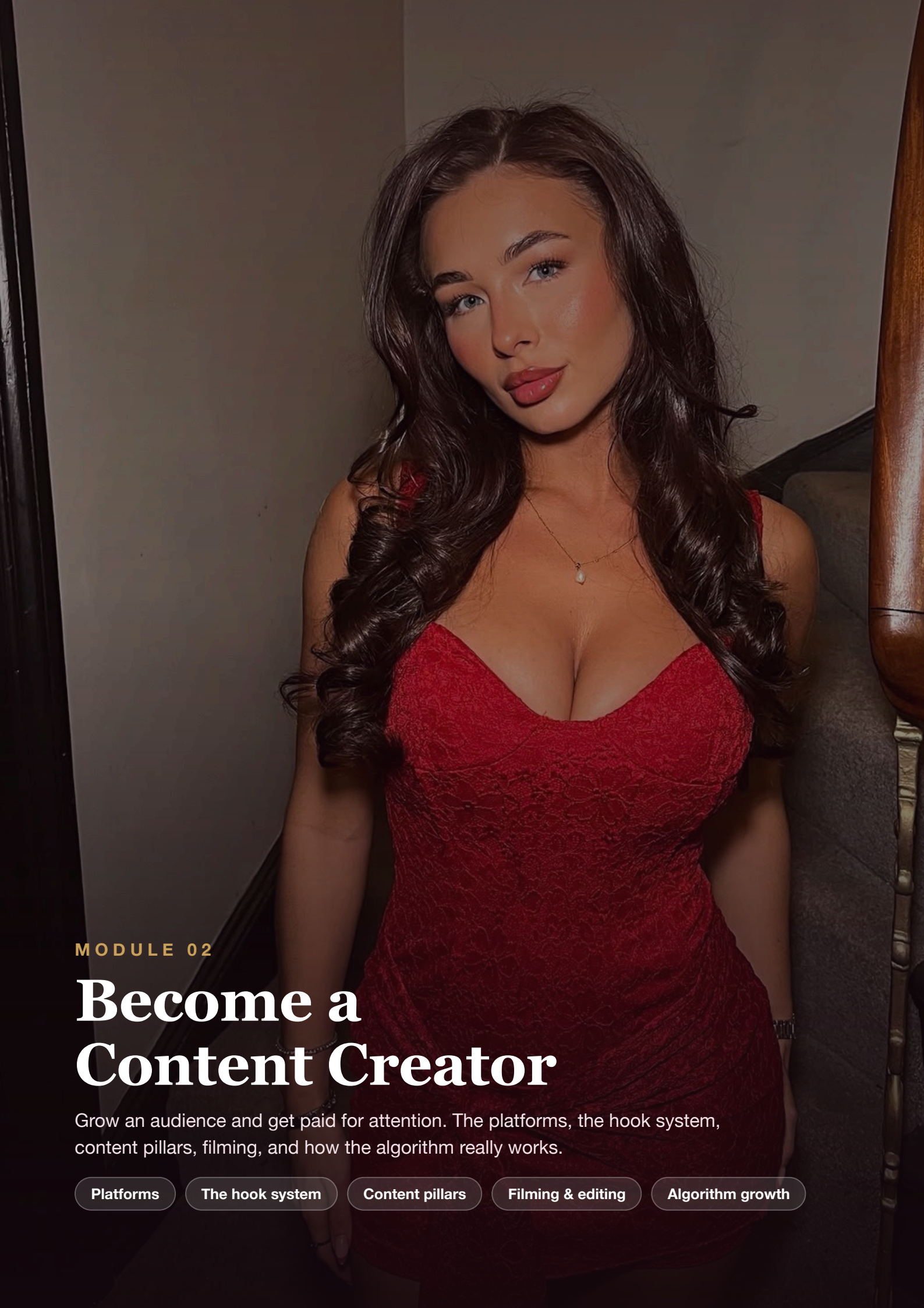
Work backwards

- ✦ Want **£2,000/month**? That's just **2 clients at £1,000**, or 8–10 UGC videos, or one solid brand deal a week.
- ✦ Break the number into **units you can count** — clients, videos, deals — then chase the units, not the money.

Your income is a decision, not a wage.

Nobody is going to give you a raise. In this game you give yourself one by adding a client, a stream, or a price rise.

Do this now: write your 90-day income target and the number of units it takes to hit it.



MODULE 02

Become a Content Creator

Grow an audience and get paid for attention. The platforms, the hook system, content pillars, filming, and how the algorithm really works.

Platforms

The hook system

Content pillars

Filming & editing

Algorithm growth



THE ROLE

What a creator actually does.

A content creator turns ideas into posts that grow an audience — then turns that audience into income. Your job is two things: **make things people want to watch**, and **build trust**.

Where to post (and why)



TikTok

Fastest growth. Best place to start from zero — the algorithm shows new creators to new people.



Instagram

Where brands look and money lives. Reels for reach, feed & stories for trust.



YouTube

Long-term authority and searchable income (incl. Shorts). Slower, but compounds.

Start with one platform (I recommend TikTok), master it, then repurpose the same content everywhere. One idea → many posts.

The creator's weekly job

- ♦ **Plan** — decide the week's ideas from your pillars.
- ♦ **Batch** — film several at once; it's 10× more efficient.
- ♦ **Post & engage** — reply to every comment for the first hour.
- ♦ **Review** — check which posts worked and do more of that.



THE HOOK SYSTEM

Win the first 2 seconds.

People decide in about two seconds whether to keep watching. Master the **hook** and everything else takes care of itself — it's the single biggest lever in short-form video.

Hook formulas that work

- ♦ **The bold claim** — "This grew my page to 100k in 30 days."
- ♦ **The mistake** — "Stop doing this if you want to grow."
- ♦ **Curiosity gap** — "Nobody tells you this about brand deals..."
- ♦ **Relatable call-out** — "POV: you're posting and getting no views."
- ♦ **Result first** — show the after, then explain how.

Retention beats everything. After the hook, keep them watching: fast cuts, on-screen captions, one idea per video, and a reason to reach the end (a payoff, a list, a reveal).

The simple video structure

- 1 Hook (0–2s)**
Stop the scroll with one of the formulas above.
- 2 Value (2–20s)**
Deliver the thing you promised — clearly, quickly, one idea.
- 3 Payoff + CTA**
End strong. Tell them to follow, comment, or save.

Do this now: write 10 hooks for your niche. Film the 3 best today.



PILLARS & CALENDAR

Never run out of ideas.

Content pillars are 3–5 themes you always post about. They keep you consistent, on-brand, and out of the "what do I post today?" trap.

Example pillars (fitness creator)

- ✦ **Educate** — tips, how-tos, myths
- ✦ **Relate** — day-in-the-life, struggles
- ✦ **Inspire** — transformations, wins
- ✦ **Sell** — products, services, offers

The 3:1 rule — for every 3 posts that give value, 1 can sell. Give far more than you ask.

A simple weekly calendar

Day	Pillar	Format
Mon	Educate	Talking-head tip
Wed	Relate	Day-in-the-life
Fri	Inspire	Result / story
Sun	Sell / trend	Offer or trending audio

Batch it: film a whole week in one 90-minute session. Consistency is the algorithm's favourite thing.



FILMING & EDITING

Make it look pro (on a phone).

You do not need a fancy camera. You need good light, clear sound, and clean edits. Here's the whole kit and the workflow.

The £0–£100 kit

- ✦ **Your phone** — the camera is plenty good.
- ✦ **Natural light** or a cheap ring light.
- ✦ **A tripod / phone stand** (~£15).
- ✦ **A clip mic** for talking videos (~£25).

Best free editing apps

- ✦ **CapCut** — the industry standard, free.
- ✦ **InShot** — quick and simple.
- ✦ **In-app editors** — post natively for reach.

The editing checklist

- ✓ **Captions on** — most people watch on mute.
- ✓ **Cut the dead air** — trim every pause; keep it snappy.
- ✓ **Trending or clean audio** — check the platform's trending sounds.
- ✓ **Hook on screen** — put your hook as text in the first frame.
- ✓ **Vertical & full-screen** — 9:16, no borders.

Done beats perfect. Your 50th video will be miles better than your first — so get to your 50th fast.

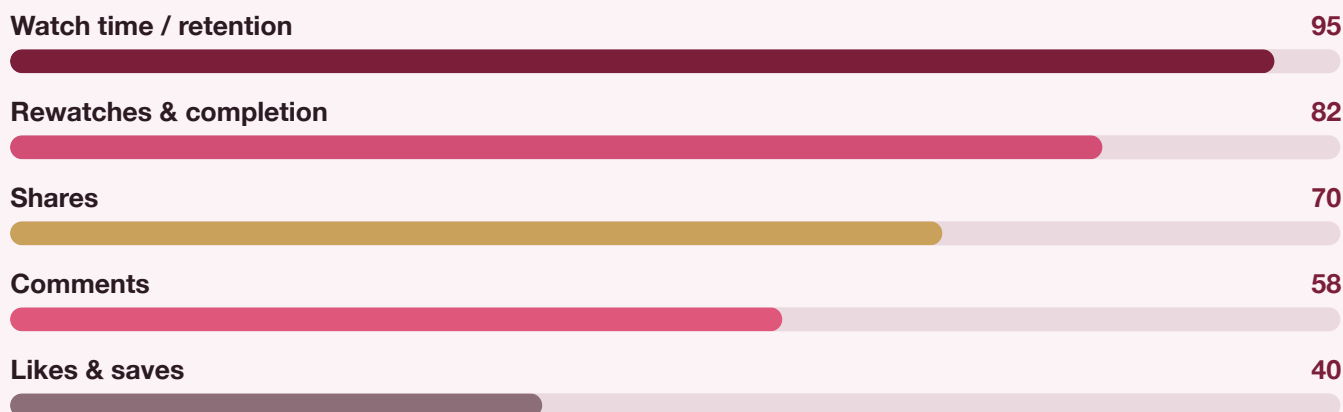


GROW YOUR FOLLOWING

How the algorithm really works.

The algorithm isn't magic. It shows a video to a small test group, watches how they react, and pushes the winners to more people. Your job is to win the test.

The signals that matter (in order)



- ✦ **Hook for retention** — the more they watch, the more it spreads.
- ✦ **Make it shareable** — a share is the strongest signal; give people a reason to send it to a friend.
- ✦ **Reply to comments** — early engagement tells the algorithm it's hot.
- ✦ **Post consistently** — 1x/day beats 7x on Monday and nothing after.
- ✦ **Ride trends fast** — trending audio and formats get a boost.

Don't chase followers — chase reach. Views bring followers, brand deals and clients. A single video can change your life; I've had 18M+ likes on one post.

Do this now: post one video a day for 14 days. Review what worked on day 15.



MODULE 03

Become a Social Media Manager

The fastest way to real income. You don't need a following — you need a service and a system. Find clients, pitch, onboard, deliver and keep them.

The services

Find clients

Pitch scripts

Onboarding

Reporting



THE ROLE

Get paid to run their socials.

Millions of businesses know they need social media and have zero time or skill to do it. That gap is your income. As an SMM you run their accounts for a **monthly fee** — recurring, predictable money.

Services you can offer

- ◆ **Content creation** — posts, reels, stories
- ◆ **Scheduling & posting**
- ◆ **Caption & hashtag writing**
- ◆ **Community management** — replies & DMs
- ◆ **Strategy & content plans**
- ◆ **Filming days** at their business
- ◆ **Paid ads** (add-on, higher fee)
- ◆ **Monthly reporting**

You can start today with zero following. Clients pay for the **outcome** (more customers, a professional presence), not your personal follower count.

Who to target first

- ◆ **Local businesses** — gyms, salons, cafés, dentists, trades, restaurants.
- ◆ **Small brands** that post inconsistently or badly.
- ◆ **Coaches & service pros** who are great at their thing, bad at posting.



FIND CLIENTS

Where the clients hide.

You don't need thousands of leads. You need **a handful of the right conversations**. Here's exactly where to look and how to start them.

Where to find them

- ✦ **Instagram search** — local businesses with weak or dead pages. That's your pitch.
- ✦ **Google Maps** — every business near you, many with no socials linked.
- ✦ **Your own network** — the fastest first client is someone who already knows you.
- ✦ **Facebook groups & local directories** — small business owners hang out there.

The outreach that works

Lead with value, not a pitch. Point out one specific thing you'd improve, or send a free idea. Make it about them, not you.

DM / email script

"Hi [name], I love what you do at [business]. I put together a couple of quick content ideas that could bring you more [customers/bookings] — want me to send them over? No strings, I just work with local businesses like yours."

- ✦ **Follow up twice.** Most sales are in the follow-up, not the first message.
- ✦ **Aim for a call**, not a sale, in the DM. Sell on the call.



PITCH & CLOSE

Turn a chat into a client.

On the call you're not begging for work — you're a professional diagnosing a problem and prescribing the fix. Follow this simple structure.

- 1 Ask & listen**
"What are you trying to get from social media?" Let them talk. Their words become your pitch.
- 2 Diagnose**
Reflect the gap: "So you want more bookings but you're posting twice a month with no plan."
- 3 Prescribe a package**
Offer one clear package with a monthly price. Don't overwhelm with options.
- 4 Handle price calmly**
Frame it as ROI: "One new customer a month covers this. I'll aim for far more."
- 5 Close**
"Shall we start Monday? I'll send the details and we'll get going."

Confidence is the close. You're solving a real problem. Say your price, then stop talking.

Do this now: book 3 calls this week. You only need one yes.



ONBOARD & DELIVER

Run it like a pro.

Great delivery keeps clients paying for years. Set it up properly from day one and it runs like a machine.

The onboarding checklist

- ✓ **Contract signed** & first invoice paid before any work.
- ✓ **Access** — logins or added as a manager (never post from your own login).
- ✓ **Brand basics** — logo, colours, fonts, tone, do's & don'ts.
- ✓ **Content plan** approved for month one.
- ✓ **Filming day** booked to bank a batch of content.

The monthly workflow

Week	What you do
1	Plan the month, film/gather content, get approval
2–3	Schedule & post, manage comments & DMs
4	Engage, review numbers, prep next month's plan
End	Send the report, invoice for next month

Batch across clients. Do all planning on one day, all editing on another. Systems let you handle 5+ clients without burning out.



KEEP CLIENTS

Results = retention.

Winning a client is hard; keeping one is easy — if you show results and communicate. A retained client is money every single month without re-selling.

The monthly report (keep it simple)

- ✦ **Reach & views** — up or down vs last month.
- ✦ **Follower growth** and engagement rate.
- ✦ **Best posts** — what worked and why.
- ✦ **Leads / bookings / clicks** — the number they actually care about.
- ✦ **Next month's plan** — always end looking forward.

Communicate proactively. A quick weekly message ("here's what's going out this week") makes clients feel looked after — and stops them ever wondering what they pay for.

Grow the account (and the invoice)

- ✦ Once you're delivering, **upsell**: ads, a second platform, a filming day, a website.
- ✦ Ask happy clients for **referrals and a testimonial** — your next clients come from your current ones.

Do this now: build a one-page report template you can reuse for every client.



MODULE 04

Branding That Sells

People buy brands they trust. This is how to build a look and a voice — for yourself and for clients — that feels premium and converts.

Brand foundations

Visual identity

Voice & bio

Positioning



FOUNDATIONS

A brand is a feeling.

Your brand is what people feel when they see your name. Nail the fundamentals and you become memorable, recommendable and premium — able to charge more.

The five brand foundations

- ◆ **Purpose** — what you stand for and who you help.
- ◆ **Personality** — are you bold, warm, luxe, playful, expert?
- ◆ **Promise** — the result people get from you.
- ◆ **Look** — colours, fonts, imagery (next page).
- ◆ **Voice** — how you sound in captions and DMs.

Consistency is the whole trick. Same colours, same tone, same energy — everywhere. Repetition builds recognition, and recognition builds trust.

People don't buy the best product. They buy the brand they trust the most.

Do this now: write three words that describe how you want people to feel about your brand. Everything you make should match them.



VISUAL IDENTITY

Your look, locked in.

A simple, consistent visual identity makes you look established — even on day one. You only need a few decisions, then you repeat them forever.

Colours

- ✦ Pick **1 main, 1 accent, 1–2 neutrals**.
- ✦ Use them consistently across posts, highlights and your site.
- ✦ Colour creates instant recognition in a busy feed.

Fonts

- ✦ One characterful **heading** font.
- ✦ One clean **body** font.
- ✦ Never more than two — it looks messy.

The starter brand kit

- ✓ **Logo / wordmark** — even just your name in your font.
- ✓ **Colour palette** — hex codes saved.
- ✓ **2 fonts** — heading + body.
- ✓ **Profile photo & highlight covers** — on-brand.
- ✓ **Templates** — a couple of reusable post layouts (Canva is perfect).

Tool tip: build the whole kit free in **Canva**. Save it as a Brand Kit so every design stays consistent.



VOICE & BIO

Sound like someone worth following.

Your words do as much as your visuals. A clear voice and a sharp bio turn profile visits into follows and enquiries.

Find your voice

- ✦ Write like you **talk** — read captions out loud; if it sounds stiff, rewrite.
- ✦ Pick a lane: **warm & relatable**, **bold & direct**, or **expert & calm**.
- ✦ Be consistent so people can "hear" you.

The bio formula

[Who you help] + [what you help them do] + [proof or personality] + [call to action].

e.g. "Helping local gyms fill classes with scroll-stopping content 🙌 300k+ views for clients · DM 'GROW' to start."

Positioning: be the obvious choice

- ✦ **Niche + result** beats "I do social media." Specific gets booked.
- ✦ Show **proof** — results, testimonials, before/after — the moment you have any.
- ✦ Have **one clear next step** everywhere (follow, DM a word, click the link).

Do this now: rewrite your bio with the formula above.



MODULE 05

Build Websites (& Sell Them)

A website makes you look real and gives clients somewhere to book. Learn to build one with no code — then sell the same service for £500–£2,500 a time.

Why sites win

Structure

No-code build

Sell as a service



WHY & WHAT

Every brand needs a home.

Social media is rented land; a website is land you own. It's where people book you, buy from you, and take you seriously — and it's a service you can sell to every client.

What a great site does

- ◆ **Builds trust** — a real site says "real business".
- ◆ **Captures leads** — enquiry forms, email sign-ups.
- ◆ **Sells 24/7** — services, products, bookings.
- ◆ **Shows proof** — portfolio, testimonials, results.

The pages almost every site needs

Page	Job
Home	Hook, what you do, proof, clear call-to-action
About	Story & trust — why you
Services / Shop	What they can buy and the price/next step
Portfolio	Results & testimonials
Contact / Book	Form, calendar, socials

One golden rule: every page points to one clear action — book, buy, or enquire.



BUILD IT (NO CODE)

Live in a weekend.

You do not need to code. Modern drag-and-drop builders let anyone make a beautiful, professional site — here's the workflow I use.

Pick a builder

Wix / Squarespace

Easiest for beginners. Gorgeous templates, drag-and-drop, hosting built in.

Framer / Carrd

Sleek and modern. Carrd is perfect (and cheap) for one-page sites.

Shopify

The choice when they're selling products online.

The build steps

1 Start from a template

Pick one close to the vibe — don't start blank.

2 Swap in their brand

Colours, fonts, logo, photos, real copy.

3 Write clear copy

Benefit-led headlines, short paragraphs, buttons everywhere.

4 Connect the essentials

Domain, contact form, socials, booking/payment.

5 Check mobile & launch

Most visitors are on a phone — test it there first.



SELL IT

Turn a skill into £500–£2,500.

Once you can build one site, you can build them for clients — and it pairs perfectly with social media management. Same clients, extra income.

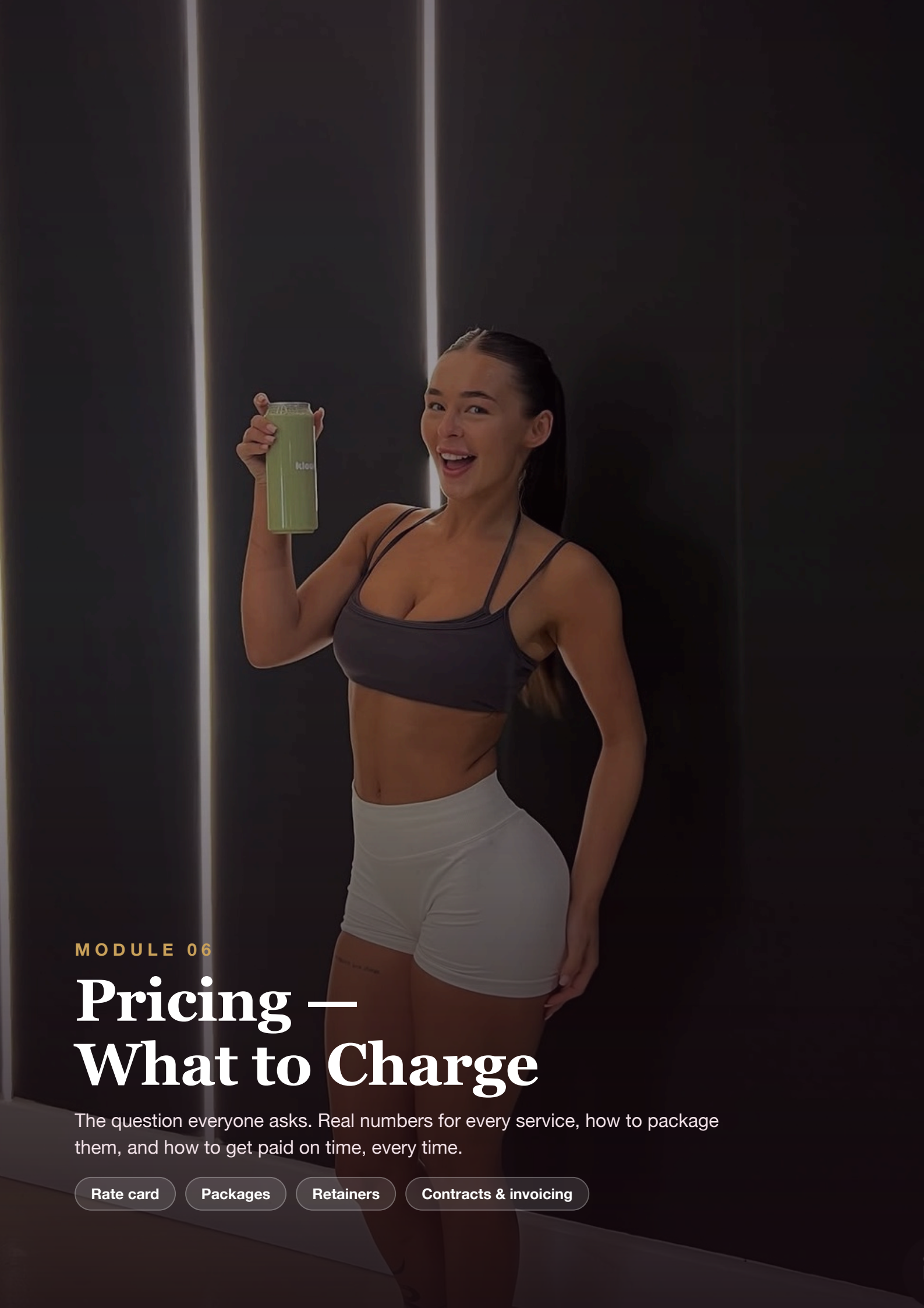
Website packages

Package	What's included	Price
One-pager	Single scrolling page, form, socials	£400–£800
Business site	4–6 pages, copy, branding, SEO basics	£900–£2,500
Online shop	Products, payments, setup & training	£2,500–£6,000
Care plan	Hosting, updates & edits (recurring)	£30–£100/mo

The care plan is the gold. Build once, then charge monthly to maintain it — recurring income on top of the build fee.

- ✦ **Bundle it:** "Website + social media management" is an easy, high-value offer.
- ✦ **Show, don't tell:** build one demo site for a dream client and use it to win more.

Do this now: rebuild a local business's weak site as a free demo. It becomes your portfolio and your pitch.

A woman with long dark hair, wearing a dark grey sports bra and white high-waisted shorts, is smiling and holding a green smoothie in a clear bottle. She is standing in a dark room with two vertical light strips behind her. The bottle has the word 'klos' on it.

MODULE 06

Pricing — What to Charge

The question everyone asks. Real numbers for every service, how to package them, and how to get paid on time, every time.

Rate card

Packages

Retainers

Contracts & invoicing



THE RATE CARD

What to actually charge.

Undercharging is the #1 mistake beginners make. Here are real market ranges — start near the lower end while you build proof, then raise your prices every few clients.

Service	What it is	Price
SMM — Starter	1 platform, ~12 posts/mo	£400–£600/mo
SMM — Growth	2 platforms, reels, engagement	£800–£1,200/mo
SMM — Premium	Full management + strategy + reporting	£1,500–£3,000/mo
UGC video	Single branded video	£120–£300
Brand deal post	Per platform (scales with reach)	£250–£2,000+
Content / filming day	Batch of photo & video	£400–£800
Website	One-pager → business site	£400–£2,500
Branding kit	Logo, colours, fonts, templates	£250–£1,500
Consulting / coaching	Per hour	£60–£150/hr

Price on value, not hours. A post that brings a client £5,000 is worth far more than the 30 minutes it took you.



PACKAGES & RETAINERS

Sell outcomes, not tasks.

Never sell "posts". Sell a **package** with a clear outcome and a monthly price. Packages are easier to buy, easier to deliver, and far more profitable.

Build three tiers

Good

The essentials at an easy-yes price. Gets them in the door.

£400–£600/mo

Better

Your main offer — most clients pick this. Make it the obvious value.

£800–£1,200/mo

Best

Everything, done for them. Anchors your pricing and lands whales.

£1,500–£3,000/mo

The middle wins. Most people choose the middle option — so build your best offer there and price the others around it.

Why retainers change your life

- ♦ **Predictable income** — you start each month already earning.
- ♦ **Less selling** — win a client once, get paid for months.
- ♦ **Compounding** — 5 clients at £1,000 = £5,000/mo, every month.

Do this now: write your three packages with names, deliverables and prices.



GET PAID PROPERLY

Contracts, invoices, protection.

Treat it like the business it is. A simple contract and clean invoicing protect you, build trust, and get you paid on time.

Always use a simple contract

- ✦ **Scope** — exactly what's included (and what's not).
- ✦ **Price & payment terms** — amount, date, how they pay.
- ✦ **Rolling monthly** with 30 days' notice to cancel.
- ✦ **Usage & access** — who owns what, logins.

Invoicing that gets paid

- ✓ **Invoice upfront** — payment before the month's work (or 50% up front on projects).
- ✓ **Use a tool** — free invoicing in Wave, PayPal, Stripe or Wise.
- ✓ **Set auto-reminders** — chase late payers automatically.
- ✓ **Keep records** — save every invoice for your tax return.

Register as self-employed once you're earning, and put ~20–30% aside for tax. Boring, but it keeps you free.

Do this now: set up a free invoicing account and save a contract template so you're ready for client one.



MODULE 07

Grow, Monetise & Scale

Stack multiple income streams, land brand deals, build a funnel that grows itself, and turn a solo hustle into a business that scales.

Income streams

Brand deals

Funnels & email

Scaling to an agency



INCOME STREAMS

Never rely on one payday.

The creators who last don't have one income — they have several, feeding each other. Here's the mix and roughly how it balances out.



- ✦ **Brand deals** — paid posts; scale with your reach.
- ✦ **Client work** — SMM & websites; your reliable base.
- ✦ **UGC** — content for brands you don't even post yourself.
- ✦ **Affiliate & commissions** — earn a cut on every sale via your link.
- ✦ **Your own products** — guides, presets, courses; you keep almost all of it.

Add one at a time. Get one stream working before you start the next — don't spread yourself thin.



EARN WHILE YOU SLEEP

Your content keeps working.

Here's the part that changes everything: you keep earning **even when you're not posting**. Do the work once, and it pays you again and again — this is how income grows exponentially with you.

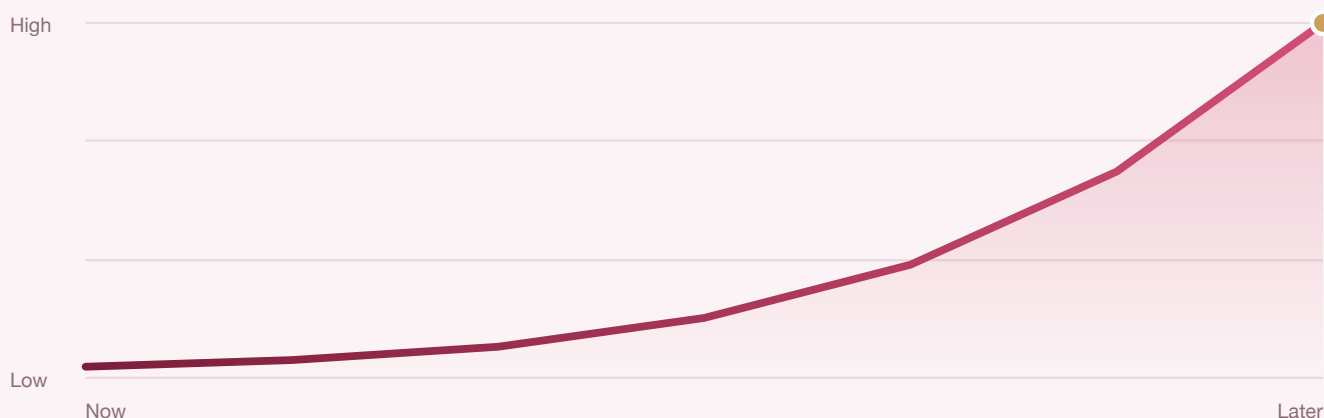
Your content doesn't expire

- ✦ **Evergreen posts keep selling.** A TikTok that did well stays out there — people find it days, weeks and months later and still buy.
- ✦ **One video, endless sales.** A single post can earn for you today, next week and next year. You filmed it once.
- ✦ **Your back-catalogue is an asset.** Every post becomes a little salesperson working 24/7 while you sleep, travel, or film the next one.

Income that needs no new work

- ✦ **Affiliate links** in old posts and your bio pay commissions around the clock.
- ✦ **Digital products** — guides, presets, courses — sell infinitely with nothing to restock.
- ✦ **Retainers & memberships** pay you every month for work you've already systemised.

Why it compounds: as your audience grows, every new post reaches more people — and your old posts keep pulling in that bigger audience too. Growth stacks on growth. That's the difference between a wage (linear) and an asset (exponential).



The goal: build assets — content, audience, products — once, and let them pay you on repeat. That's real freedom.



LAND BRAND DEALS

Get paid to post.

You don't need a million followers — brands pay **engaged, niche** creators of every size. You often have to make the first move.

How to land them

- ✦ **Tag & feature brands you already love** — show them what working with you looks like.
- ✦ **Pitch directly** — a short, confident email to their marketing team.
- ✦ **Have a media kit** — one page: who you are, your stats, past work, rates.
- ✦ **Sign up to creator platforms** that connect brands and creators.

The pitch email

"Hi [brand], I'm [name] — I create [niche] content for an audience of [who]. My recent posts have hit [reach/engagement] and your product is a perfect fit. I'd love to create [idea] for you — here's my media kit. Are you open to a collab?"

Know your worth. Charge per deliverable and per platform. As your reach grows, your rates grow — don't work for "exposure" once you can help it.

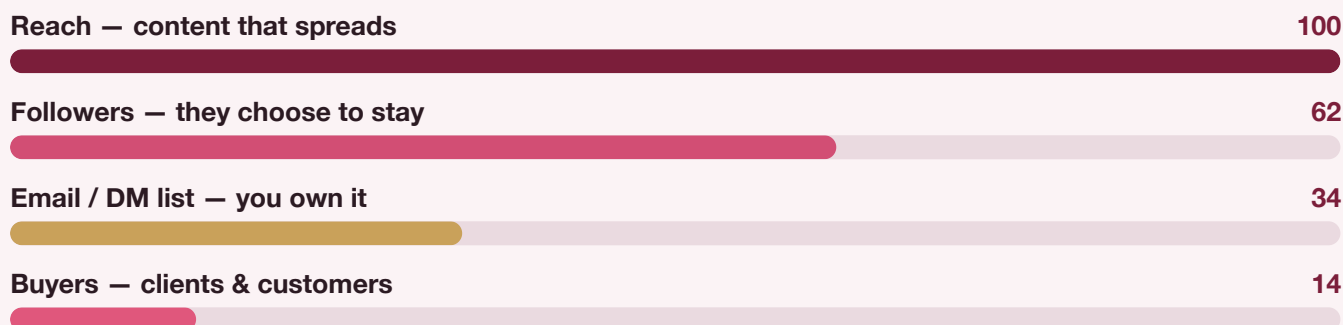


FUNNELS & SCALING

Build a machine.

To grow past yourself you need a **funnel** (attention → audience → income) and eventually a **team** so the business doesn't depend only on you.

The simple creator funnel

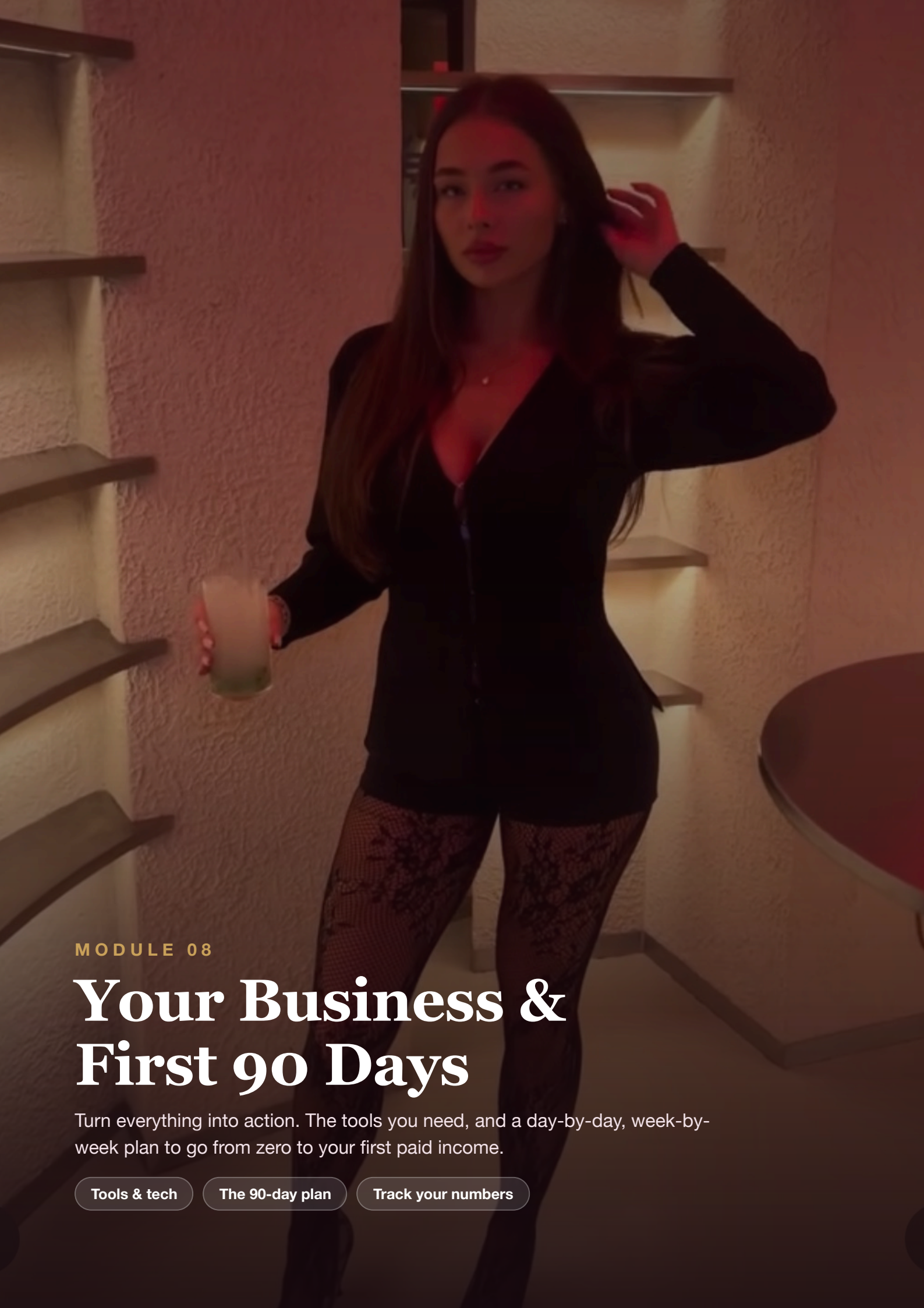


- ✦ **Capture the audience you own** — an email list or a "DM me X" system beats renting followers.
- ✦ **Nurture** — give value, build trust, then make offers.
- ✦ **Repurpose** — one idea into TikTok, Reels, Shorts, a post and an email.

Scaling to an agency

- ✦ **Systemise** everything into templates and checklists (like this playbook).
- ✦ **Outsource** the parts you don't need to do — editing first, then posting.
- ✦ **Raise prices** and take on fewer, better clients.

Do this now: start collecting emails/DMs today — the audience you own is the most valuable asset you'll build.



MODULE 08

Your Business & First 90 Days

Turn everything into action. The tools you need, and a day-by-day, week-by-week plan to go from zero to your first paid income.

Tools & tech

The 90-day plan

Track your numbers



TOOLS & TECH STACK

Everything you need (mostly free).

You can run this whole business from your phone and a laptop. Here's the complete toolkit — start with the free ones.

Create

- ✦ **CapCut / InShot** — editing
- ✦ **Canva** — graphics, branding, templates
- ✦ **Lightroom** — photo editing

Manage

- ✦ **Later / Metricool** — scheduling & analytics
- ✦ **Notion / Trello** — plan clients & content
- ✦ **Google Drive** — store & share content

Get paid

- ✦ **Wave / PayPal / Stripe** — invoices
- ✦ **Wise** — get paid internationally

Grow

- ✦ **ChatGPT** — ideas, captions, outreach drafts
- ✦ **Website builder** — Wix, Squarespace, Carrd
- ✦ **A link-in-bio** — Stan, Beacons, Linktree

Don't buy everything. Start with CapCut, Canva and a free scheduler. Add tools only when a real need appears.



YOUR FIRST 90 DAYS

The exact plan.

Here's how to turn this guide into income. Follow it and you'll have posted consistently, pitched real clients, and set up to get paid — in three months.

Phase	Focus	Goal
Days 1–7	Pick path & niche, set up profile & bio, write 10 hooks	Ready to launch
Days 8–30	Post daily, learn the hook system, batch content	First content out, first followers
Days 31–60	Build brand kit & a demo site, list your packages, start outreach	Booked first calls
Days 61–90	Close your first client, deliver, get a testimonial, raise prices	First paid income 🎉

Consistency beats talent, every time.

The people who win aren't the most gifted — they're the ones who kept posting, kept pitching, and kept improving when others quit.

Do this now: put these four phases in your calendar with a start date. Today.



TRACK YOUR NUMBERS

What gets measured grows.

You don't need to obsess over analytics — but check a few numbers weekly so you know what's working and double down.

Your weekly dashboard

Reach

How many people saw you — the top of everything

Engagement

Saves, shares & comments — quality of attention

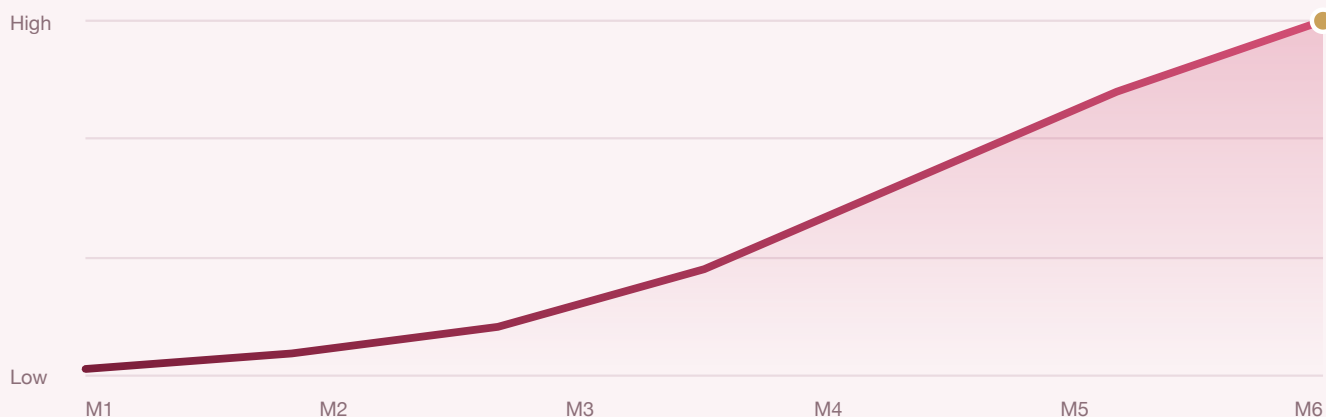
Followers

Growth rate, not just the total

Income

Leads, clients & £ — the number that counts

Example: 6 months of consistent effort



It's a curve, not a line. The first weeks feel slow — that's normal. Momentum compounds. Keep going and the graph takes off.

Rule: review weekly, adjust monthly, never quit on a bad week.



Louise Thomson
THE PLAYBOOK

YOU'VE GOT THE MAP — NOW GET THE GUIDE

Let's do this together.

This playbook gives you the what. My Academy gives you the how — with me — step by step, with feedback, templates, and a community doing it alongside you.

The Louise Thomson Academy is opening soon.

Full video training on everything in this guide — content, social media management, branding, websites, pricing and scaling — plus live Q&As, a resource vault, and a bookable creator directory once you're ready to get paid. **Follow me and turn on notifications** to be first in — early members get the best price.

Join the waitlist — follow @lou1sethomson



Instagram — [instagram.com/lou1sethomson](https://www.instagram.com/lou1sethomson)



TikTok — [tiktok.com/@lou1sethomsonx](https://www.tiktok.com/@lou1sethomsonx)